

Mac OS X plugged

Apple released a security update which secures close to twelve security loop holes

Gmail leaks

Misdirected emails reveal privileged information, the recipient is liable if the information is disclosed

REPORT

page of Punjab National Bank. We got in touch with the Head Office of Punjab National Bank in Delhi, but the response we got was these emails were common and people should be educated about it.

Online has its own advantages

It would be unfair to blame the online shopping space for scams and frauds. There are stringent measures in place to prevent users from logging in fraudulently. This has been a blessing in disguise for online shopping. It's easier shopping with a stolen card than it is to commit fraud online. Recently, the Reserve Bank of India has made it mandatory for all transactions online to be registered by either credit service providers — Visa (Verified by Visa) and MasterCard (MasterCard Secure).

Essentially, all credit card users in India would have to register with their banks and be assigned an additional password to serve as one more level of added security.

At any point in time, eBay India has around 3,50,000 items available that you can sort by price, make, style and several other factors — all in the comfort of your home. eBay is protected by PaisaPay, which differs slightly from PayPal. While PayPal is a wallet of sorts that behaves as an interface between your bank accounts/credit/debit cards and the merchant, PaisaPay is a secure payment gateway exclusive to eBay India. With PaisaPay, all your information to and from eBay India's servers is encrypted, and secure.



Rajiv Chadha, Vice President, Verisign India

Besides, you can also track the status of your order through SMS.

We spoke to Rajiv Chadha, VP, VeriSign who shared some startling figures with us — “38 per cent of Internet users in India do not use different passwords for multiple log-ins. A minuscule five per cent adopt virtual keyboards to log in their details. Merely 11 per cent of internet users in India look out for the authenticity of the web site by looking at the security provider. Only as many as 32 per cent internet users in India create a secret question that only they can answer. As many as 83 per cent Indian internet users do not look for secure web sites (https:). Only 9 per cent of internet users in India are aware of green URL bars as the sign of a secure web site.”

It doesn't end there. By being so casual about financial matters, Indians are just staying vulnerable to scams online. Mr. Chadha added, “There are many ways in which compromised credentials can be used fraudulently — and without the end-user's knowledge. It is very important to also note that these activities might not occur immediately after the information is captured. The information could be sold to different parties and can be used over a long period of time”. This makes it all the more important to be aware of the various ways in which personal information can be captured and take precautions to lower the risk.

You can email spoofs@ebay.com and mention any seller you feel cannot be trusted. All intimations at this id are shared with the Indian Computer Emergency Response Team (CERT) which is a watchdog that alerts users of frauds and infections and attacks we need to be aware of.

If you have an online account, an internet banking account, or a credit/debit card then ensuring privacy and safe



Deepa Thomas, Senior Manager, Corporate Communication, eBay India

custody of the card and log-in details is your responsibility.

But what about the real world?

With plastic money fast replacing cash transactions, what if your card falls into the wrong hands? Of course the bank will disable the card as soon as you intimate. But it's this interim time period that we're concerned about.

There are certain safety measures that have been built into the system. Possibly the most fool proof of them all is having a photo debit/credit card. If the mug shot on the card does not match the person handing over the card, counter staff can easily figure out if something is amiss.

The second important safeguard is in the form of a PIN number that has to be entered each time to validate a transaction. Again there are a few banks such as SBI that offer this facility. But the most basic protection is the signature at the back. You would've probably noticed a block print underneath the box on the rear of the card that says AUTHORISED SIGNATURE — NOT VALID UNLESS

CRACK THE CODE

Note down every Nth letter of the following sentence (ignore punctuation marks), starting with the first letter of the sentence. The letters you have are an anagram. Unscramble them to get the answer (three words). Go back to the place that directed you here, and enter the answer there. If you played by the rules, you know what the value of N is. Eg. if n=5, you get CDAROUND

Can code be hacked? Race to a cloud can do it.